

Northstar Analytics

Employee Handbook

A fictional, text-based sample document created specifically for learning PDF extraction, chunking, embeddings, semantic search, vector databases, and Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG).

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Important: Northstar Analytics is fictional. All policies, names, numbers, and procedures in this document are synthetic and are not legal, HR, financial, or employment advice.

1. About Northstar Analytics

1.1 Company Overview

Northstar Analytics is a fictional data and software company that develops analytics products for retail, logistics, and energy organizations. The company operates from three offices: Jakarta, Singapore, and Kuala Lumpur. Employees may work with colleagues across all three locations.

1.2 Working Principles

Northstar Analytics organizes its work around four principles: clarity, ownership, evidence, and respect. Teams are expected to document important decisions, use data when appropriate, communicate risks early, and treat colleagues professionally.

1.3 Standard Working Hours

The standard work week is 40 hours, Monday through Friday. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 local time. Employees may arrange their remaining working hours with their manager as long as business and team needs are met.

2. Employment and Onboarding

2.1 Probation Period

New permanent employees complete a three-month probation period. A manager conducts a review near the end of the probation period and records the outcome with People Operations.

2.2 Onboarding

During the first week, employees receive access to required systems, complete security and privacy training, meet their team, and review their first 30-day objectives. Mandatory onboarding modules should be completed within ten working days.

2.3 Employee Records

Employees are responsible for keeping their contact information, emergency contact, and bank details current. Changes should be submitted to People Operations within five working days.

3. Leave Policy

3.1 Annual Leave

Full-time employees receive 18 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Employees who join during the year receive annual leave on a prorated basis. Annual leave requests of three working days or fewer should normally be submitted at least five working days in advance. Requests longer than three working days should normally be submitted at least ten working days in advance.

3.2 Carryover

Up to five unused annual leave days may be carried into the next calendar year. Carried-over leave must be used by March 31. Any remaining carried-over balance after March 31 expires unless People Operations has approved an exception in writing.

3.3 Sick Leave

Employees receive up to 12 working days of paid sick leave per calendar year. A medical certificate is required when sick leave lasts for three consecutive working days or more.

3.4 Parental Leave

Eligible employees may take 16 weeks of paid primary caregiver leave or four weeks of paid secondary caregiver leave following the birth or legal adoption of a child. Local statutory requirements apply where they provide greater benefits.

3.5 Bereavement Leave

Employees may take up to five paid working days following the death of an immediate family member. Additional unpaid leave may be discussed with the employee's manager and People Operations.

4. Remote and Hybrid Work

4.1 Hybrid Schedule

Employees assigned to a hybrid role are expected to work from their designated office at least two days per week. Teams may establish common office days when in-person collaboration is useful.

4.2 Remote Work Location

Employees may work remotely from within their country of employment when their role permits it. Working from another country requires written approval from People Operations and Information Security before travel begins.

4.3 Equipment

The company provides one laptop, one laptop charger, and a standard headset for employees whose roles require computer access. Employees may request an external monitor for their primary work location, subject to manager approval.

5. Travel and Expenses

5.1 Business Travel Approval

Business travel must be approved by the employee's manager before booking. International travel also requires approval from the relevant department head.

5.2 Air Travel

Economy class is the standard for flights under six hours. Premium economy may be booked for flights lasting six hours or longer with manager approval. Business class requires executive approval.

5.3 Accommodation

Employees should select safe, practical accommodation close to the business location. The guideline hotel limit is USD 180 per night before taxes, unless local market conditions make the limit impractical.

5.4 Meals

The daily meal allowance for approved business travel is USD 45. Alcoholic beverages are not reimbursable. Employees do not need individual meal receipts when using the daily allowance.

5.5 Expense Submission

Travel and business expenses should be submitted within 15 calendar days after the expense is incurred or the trip ends. Receipts are required for individual expenses above USD 25.

6. Learning and Development

6.1 Annual Learning Budget

Each permanent employee receives an annual learning budget of USD 600. The budget may be used for approved courses, books, certification exams, workshops, and professional conferences related to the employee's role or development plan.

6.2 Approval

Learning expenses above USD 150 require manager approval before purchase. Certification exam fees may be reimbursed after the employee provides proof of registration.

6.3 Learning Time

Employees may use up to four working hours per month for structured professional learning when workload permits. Learning time should be coordinated with the employee's manager.

7. Information Security

7.1 Passwords and Authentication

Employees must use company-approved authentication methods and enable multi-factor authentication when it is available. Passwords must not be shared with colleagues or stored in unapproved documents.

7.2 Company Devices

Company devices must use approved security software and automatic screen locking. Employees must report a lost or stolen company device to Information Security within one hour of discovering

the loss.

7.3 Confidential Information

Confidential company or customer information must only be stored in approved systems. Employees should use the minimum amount of sensitive information necessary for their work.

7.4 Security Incidents

Suspected phishing, accidental data disclosure, malware, or unauthorized access should be reported immediately through the security incident channel. Employees should not attempt to investigate a suspected attacker on their own.

8. Performance and Feedback

8.1 Goal Setting

Employees and managers set role objectives at the beginning of each half-year. Objectives should describe expected outcomes and, where practical, measurable indicators.

8.2 Check-ins

Managers should hold a one-to-one meeting with each direct report at least twice per month. These meetings may cover priorities, blockers, feedback, development, and workload.

8.3 Performance Reviews

Formal performance reviews occur twice each year, in June and December. Review outcomes consider results, collaboration, role expectations, and demonstrated development.

9. Workplace Conduct

9.1 Professional Conduct

Employees are expected to communicate respectfully and avoid harassment, discrimination, intimidation, retaliation, and other inappropriate workplace behavior.

9.2 Conflicts of Interest

Employees must disclose actual or potential conflicts of interest to their manager or People Operations. Examples include significant financial interests in a supplier or supervising a close family member.

9.3 Gifts

Employees may accept modest business gifts with a value of up to USD 50 when the gift cannot reasonably influence a business decision. Cash and cash equivalents must never be accepted.

10. Offboarding

10.1 Resignation

Employees should provide written notice according to their employment agreement. Managers and People Operations will coordinate transition activities and the employee's final working date.

10.2 Company Property

All company property must be returned no later than the final working day unless another arrangement is approved. This includes laptops, access cards, security keys, and other issued equipment.

10.3 Access Removal

System access is removed based on the employee's final working date and security requirements. Employees should transfer business records and relevant work products before departure.

11. Quick Reference

11.1 Key Policy Facts

This section summarizes selected facts from the handbook for convenience. If a summary conflicts with the detailed policy text, the detailed section should be used.

Topic	Policy
Annual leave	18 working days per calendar year
Annual leave carryover	Up to 5 days; use by March 31
Paid sick leave	Up to 12 working days per year
Primary caregiver leave	16 weeks paid
Secondary caregiver leave	4 weeks paid
Hybrid office expectation	At least 2 days per week
Learning budget	USD 600 per year
Learning time	Up to 4 working hours per month
Hotel guideline	USD 180 per night before taxes
Daily meal allowance	USD 45
Expense submission	Within 15 calendar days
Receipt threshold	Above USD 25
Lost device reporting	Within 1 hour of discovery
Performance reviews	June and December
Gift limit	Up to USD 50

End of Sample Handbook

This fictional document was intentionally designed to contain clear factual statements distributed across multiple sections and pages. It can be used to practice page-aware extraction, chunking, semantic retrieval, source attribution, and RAG evaluation.